

module-01-what-is-iks - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - primary band

Module 1 — What is IKS? (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Bhāratīya Jñāna-Paramparā* · **Band:** Primary (3-5) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

The map of Indian Knowledge Systems.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 1's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

“What’s the longest poem you’ve heard?” (a song? a story? the Hanumān Cālīsā?) Now imagine 100,000 verses kept alive only by memory — that’s the Mahābhārata.

Core idea · 15 min

IKS is a name for Indian ways of knowing. It includes math, medicine, astronomy, dance, music, building, language, and yoga.

Three big groups (write on board): - **Vedāṅgas** — six “limbs of the Veda” — śikṣā (pronunciation), kalpa (ritual procedure), vyākaraṇa (grammar), nirukta (etymology), chandas (metre), jyotiṣa (astronomy) - **Upavedas** — applied sciences — Āyurveda (medicine), Dhanurveda (martial), Gandharvaveda (arts), Sthāpatya (architecture) - **Itihāsa-purāṇa** — history-and-story texts

Pick ONE limb together; the class brainstorms what we still use from it today.

Demonstration · 10 min

The Memory Game. Read out 5 Sanskrit words slowly: *jala*, *agni*, *vāyu*, *pṛthivī*, *ākāśa* (water, fire, air, earth, space). Say them again. A third time. Now ask children to repeat — most will get all 5.

“Did you know — long ago, students learned 100,000 verses this way? That’s how the Mahābhārata survived.”

Source moment · 5 min

Tell the story of Pāṇini, the boy from Gandhāra who looked up at the stars one night and decided to write down ALL the rules of Sanskrit. *“He took 12 years. The book is called Aṣṭādhyāyī — eight chapters. People still study it today!”*

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Vedic Memory Olympics. Pair students. Each pair learns 4 Sanskrit words from one of the upavedas: e.g., - Āyurveda group: *vāta, pitta, kapha, prakṛti* - Yoga group: *āsana, prāṇāyāma, dhyāna, samādhi* - Music group: *rāga, tāla, svara, śruti*

Each pair “performs” their 4 words for the class. Repeat in chorus together. End with applause.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

Each child shares ONE Sanskrit word they remembered from today’s lesson. Round of applause for each.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Why IKS now? The mapping problem
- **Day 02** — Vedas and Vedāṅgas: the six supporting sciences
- **Day 03** — Upavedas: applied disciplines
- **Day 04** — Itihāsa and Purāṇas: history-as-story
- **Day 05** — Six Darśanas: the philosophical schools
- **Day 06** — Named figures: Pāṇini to Āryabhaṭa
- **Day 07** — Source discipline: what we can verify
- **Day 08** — IKS meets modern science: bridges and tensions
- **Day 09** — NEP 2020 and IKS integration
- **Day 10** — Synthesis project: your map of IKS

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.